

- 100 + people
- Most not frum, but very traditional crowd
- Kids attending age 10 and older
- Insights and plays different from last year, as some attended last year and year before etc.
- Called/emailed people in advance re: what they'd say/read
- Post-it notes in the Haggadah of the person leading the Seder telling exactly who would be acting/reading/saying an insight etc.
- On each seat:
 - Tzvi Freeman's Haggadah
 - 15 colorful cards looped together, each with a spiritual 'step' to think about at each of the 15 steps of the seder
 - Page with chart of the seder – What we do? Why we do it?

SEDER – GREAT PARK SYNAGOGUE – April 2013

Theme: The power of Speech

	Set up Kaaras quickly as people find their tables.
Act. Message is we have to internalize the seder.	Max: Hi! Oh, Wow - this all looks beautiful. What's going on here tonight? Alexa: Don't you know? It's Pesach!! Max: PESACH? Oh wow – isn't that when we remember some incredible stories that happened thousands of years ago in Egypt? Alexa: You go it!! Max: So much time and effort has gone into a celebration for something that happened so long ago?? Alexa: Max, It's not just about what happened long ago, but also about how all of us today can take lessons from the past, and grow as people! Every single thing we do tonight can be a life-lesson, helping us to become better people! Max: Really?? Well I see you have this book here that we will read. What lesson can we learn from that? Alexa: This book is a haggadah. HAGGADAH means: TO TELL. TO SPEAK. We are going to do a lot of speaking tonight about PESACH. But the Haggadah also reminds us that ALWAYS – not just tonight – we have to watch the way we SPEAK. You see? You've already found a life-lesson for tonight from the name of this book. The lesson is: Think about the word you SAY. Max: Oh that's a cool lesson. Okay - I'm so excited to begin! Soon we're going to sing the Mah Nishtana - "Why is this night different from all other nights...?" Alexa: Yup – and we also each ask ourselves: How am I different tonight? How am I growing and thinking of ways to find personal freedom.
SING	SING simanei Haseder.

	Kadesh: Kiddush
	Urchatz: Questions for kids. Bag of treats as prizes throughout the seder for kids and adults. Do we make a bracha when we wash hands now? What will we do right after we wash hands?
	Karpas: <i>We dip a vegetable into _____.</i> <i>Why saltwater?</i> <i>What bracha do we say on this vegetable? What should we have in mind when we say the bracha?</i>
Guest before Yachatz (Bi.B.)	Alexa mentioned a lesson about the power of speech. Well, here's a lesson that we can learn about how we sometimes need to CONTROL how we speak to others. Sometimes we silently enjoy putting down another person so that we could be elevated at their expense. At the seder, the breaking of the <i>matzah</i> which we are about to do is also a symbol for breaking another person's spirit by speaking harshly. But when coming to rebuke another, we must first wash our hands. That's why we washed hands a few moments ago. It reminds us that we need to purify <u>ourselves</u> spiritually, thus removing any personal agendas which would result in damaging rebuke. We then need to dip that satisfaction we might've received, symbolized by the good vegetable, in saltwater, to remove the egotistic layers which cause us to put down others. The salt reveals the essence of good in us, the kinder source in our hearts. That's the karpas that we did a few moments ago. Only then, when there is no other reason beside goodly intention, can we rebuke. When rebuke is given in this way, coming from the heart, from the depth of good, it can enter the heart of the other, and bring about meaningful improvement. If not, the rebuke is often best left unsaid.
	Yachatz: Which matzah do we break? What do we do with the larger half?
	Maggid:
Read in Heb – Clive.B. in Eng – J.B.	Hey Lachmo Anyo:

C.L.	Hey Lachmo Anyo: There was once a girl who wasn't a nice person. She went from one psychologist to another to try find a solution, but they each spoke to her about her past and her upbringing and she remained the not-nice person that she was. Then somebody suggested: 'Every day at lunch time, be the first to bring the platters of food to your table for everyone to enjoy.' As she started to do this, she realized that just by starting to do a kind deed, she actually began becoming a nicer person throughout the day. All it took was a single kind act which led her to doing more and more kind deeds, until she eventually changed her personality and became a better person. As we start our spiritual, personal journey, we don't just think about ourselves, but we first do an act of kindness. - we invite anyone to join our table. If you want to be a better person, you have to first do something kind of another. By virtue of caring for those in need, we will merit personal redemption, and ultimate redemption.
	Mah Nishtana. KIDS. Then everyone - we are all children of Hashem...
Bianc.L. (Read from Freeman Hagaddah)	Avodim: Now we are about to start answering the questions and telling the story: It is an embarrassing fact, but we're going to have to admit it: We started off as slaves; slaves to Par'o in Egypt. In fact, we would still be slaves today if it weren't for the fact that Hashem liberated us. If he hadn't, we should be slaves, our children would be slaves, our grandchildren would be slaves... and so on. Nobody would even have thought of the whole idea of freedom. That's why we're telling this story tonight. Even if we would all be wise and understanding, even if we all knew everything that's written in the Torah and all the holy books, we would still be telling this story tonight. And the more you tell the better. SING AVODIM
ACT	Maaseh Brabi Eliezer: T: Hi. I'm Rabbi Akiva. And these are my friends Rabbis..... We learned that it is a great thing to spend a lot of time talking about the story of our freedom from Egypt, and so we are excited to get together now and talk about that mitzvah. Sh: <i>With lomdish thumbs:</i> The Torah says to discuss our slavery every day. Other Rabbi: yes – I know, like it says in the verse in the Torah that we should..`.... Another Rabbi: no – I understand that differently – what it means is that.... BRAD/MARK – <i>interrupting</i> – Our teachers! You've been here for so many hours talking about the story of our slavery and freedom. You won't believe it but you've been here ALL night, and it's already morning time and it's time to say the Shema for the morning! Sh/Rabbi Eliezer: Can you believe we spent the ENTIRE night talking about our slavery and freedom? The truth is I never knew that it was a mitzvah to talk about the story every NIGHT. I thought it's only a mitzvah to talk about the story every DAY – in the last paragraph of the shema. But then Ben Zoma explained it to me! It says we should talk about the story "ALL the days of your life". Why does it say ALL? to include the nights! We should talk about the story at day AND at night and that's why we say the last paragraph of the shema every morning AND every night.

Alexa and L.B.	Now we will read the Hebrew text of the act you just saw: READ MA'ASEH paragraph in HEBREW
Sing. M.J. read in English	Baruch Hamokom
David J in English	Chochom
Dani J.	4 SONS: The words 'chacham ma hu omer?' mean: 'The wise son, what does he say?' But we can also read the words: "Chacham, ma hu? Omer!, meaning: "How can you tell a wise man? By what he says!" This applies to every one of the 4 sons. You can tell a lot about a person by the things he speaks about, the kind of language he uses, the tone of voice, the choice of words etc. We therefore need to pay close attention to how we speak and what we speak about...
	Rosho
Insight by Bev C.	Read text of Chacham ma hu omer.... Rasha ma hu omer... Notice that the wicked son is placed next to the wise son. This emphasizes the duty that the chacham has to reach out to the rasha and try to educate him. Each of us can really be a chacham and teach somebody who knows less than ourselves. If you know ALEF, teach ALEF to somebody who doesn't know alef. ETC. Tonight we are thinking of positive words and positive speech, and taking the time to share something that you learnt or read is certainly a beautiful way to use our power of speech.
Mrs. Bil. in English	Tam
Mr. Bil. in Hebrew	Sh'eino Yode'a Lishol
Tu read in Hebrew	Yochol merosh chodesh
Play: Jonty and Brad S.	MITCHILA: Brad: Hey Jonty. I've been trying real hard to keep up with the seder, and it's been great. But tell me, please: What are we about to read now? Jonty: We are about to tell the whole history of how we got to Egypt in the first place. Brad: Okay... Jonty: Well to really go back in history: Originally our ancestors served idols! In fact, Avraham's own father served idols. But then Avraham recognized Hashem, and Hashem promised that he would have lots of descendants!

	Brad: Okay! But how did the Avraham's children get to Egypt if they lived in Israel? Jonty: Well in Yaakov's times, there was a famine – no food! So they went to Egypt to get food. Eventually Yaakov and his whole family went to live in Egypt. Brad: It must've been hard to be Jews in a foreign country! Jonty: That's true! But Yaakov never allowed himself to be influenced by the Egyptian culture! He taught his children about their own identity. Brad: That's quite amazing. It teaches me that nowadays we also need to remember who we are and who we want to be. The people around us might be speaking or acting in certain not-nice ways. But the Torah tells us: Be a mentch. Dress as a Jew. Speak with respect and humility. Don't speak Lashon Horah. Etc. Etc. No matter what the people are doing around us, we should remember our own identity just like Yaakov and his children in Egypt. Jonty: So true! "What's right is not always popular and what's popular is not always right."
Guest?	Vehi Shomda: Sometimes Hashem will let an enemy attack and oppress us. We don't know why Hashem does this and cannot explain the pain of exile. However, one thing we do know: No matter what happens, Hashem will always be there and help us and save us. At times of exile we need to examine our lifestyle and our deeds, and make meaningful changes to become closer to Hashem. We can do this knowing with absolute confidence that Hashem loves us and will protect us.
	Vehi Shomda: SING
Tu/Sh	Tzei Ul'mad: Now we'll start telling the story of our descent to Egypt, and our liberation from there. We'll do that by taking a short passage that tells the entire story in short, and unpacking it for the details. .. <u>Our next 'stop' will be at the 10 Plagues.</u>
Sing rap (lalalalala)	<u>MAKKOS RAP ??</u> In Egypt many years ago... lalalalalal The Jews asked to leave, but par'o said no He was punished with plagues, then he searched high and low For moses to tell him to pls just go Blood filled every river and sea Even the bath, and even one's tea Then came frogs, and then there was lice, Then wild animals -not so nice! Pestilence wasn't that much fun Boils hurt, hail made them run Locusts ate the fields, then a darkness did descent Then the first-borns died.. and that's the end!
	Everyone spill onto the Makkos on the makkah place-mats

	DAYEINU: Sing. Then Each table has to say 2 or 3 personal ‘dayeinu’s’. The importance of verbalizing praise and positive speech!
Act	Rabban Gamliel: Brad: Hey - howz the seder going? Are you still awake? Mark: Yip-si-doodle! Brad: K – Well listen up! Even if you haven’t managed to say all the words in the haggadah until now, you’ve GOT to at least say 3 words. Rabbi Gamliel said that these 3 words are VERY important. So say after me (and everyone please repeat after me!) PESACH MATZAH MARROR
Mr. C. in Heb.	Rabon Gamliel
Gia read	Pesach. Shehayu... until the words ‘shene’amar’
Shelly read	Pesach. Until words ‘shene’amar’
Activity	Everyone look under chair for a thought about each of these words, and whoever has these 3 words should read it! PESACH: Pesach means to ‘skip-over’. Hashem skipped over our houses in Egypt, when He struck the Egyptians. <i>Ask yourself:</i> • How am I growing in leaps and bounds? • How can I ‘jump over’ obstacles to find inner freedom? MATZAH: We had so much faith when we left Egypt! We didn’t even have time for the bread to rise. So matzah symbolizes faith. <i>Ask yourself:</i> • Do I work on my faith, thinking about Hashem and thanking Him daily? • It times of doubt, do I Daven and communicate with Hashem? MARROR: We were bitter in Egypt. We never felt we belonged there. We never made peace with our slavery. If it hadn’t been that way, we probably would never have left. <i>Ask yourself:</i> • Do I just accept my limitations and personal ‘slavery’ or do I try to grow? • Am I complacent about my faults, or do I try to improve? • Do I try to take lessons from painful moments and then move on?

	Rachtzah: Show washing facilities. We are washing for matzah. <u>JOKE:</u> Q: What do you call someone who derives pleasure from the bread of affliction? A: A matzochist.
	Motzi - Matzah.
Fiona K.	Did you know that the word "Pesach" means "the mouth speaks." But the Hebrew name for Pharaoh is a combination of Peh Rah, meaning "the bad mouth." You see? Speech has the power to build, but it also has the power to destroy. Speech is the tool of building and construction. On the other hand, gossip drives apart families and communities. On Pesach, we use speech to "build" -- by communicating, connecting, and encouraging each other. We stay up long into the night, relating the story of our exodus, tasting and sharing the joy of freedom. It is such a privilege to be able to sit here as a community and communicate positive, meaningful words. May we continue to do so.
	Maror
	Korech
	Shulchan Orech – catered buffet
STORY	There were once two beggars who used to go around begging together. One was Jewish and the other a gentile. As the night of Passover approached, the Jewish beggar offered to help his non-Jewish friend get invited to a seder (the festive Passover meal accompanied by many commandments and rituals) and get a good meal. "Just put on some Jewish clothes and come with me to the synagogue. Everyone brings home poor guests for the seder. It's easy, you'll see." The non-Jewish beggar happily agreed. On the first night of Passover they went to the synagogue, and sure enough, both got invited to different homes for the festive ceremony. Hours later they met in a predetermined place in the local park. But to the amazement of the Jewish beggar, his friend was blazing mad. "What did you do to me?" He shouted. "You call that a meal? It was torture!! It was hell! I'll pay you back for this--you'll see..." "What do you mean? What happened?" the Jew asked. "What happened? As if you didn't know! You Jews are crazy--that's what happened! First we drank a glass of wine. I like wine, but on an empty stomach... My head started spinning a bit but I figured that any second we would begin the meal. The smell of the food from the kitchen was great. Then we ate a bit of parsley. Then they started talking, and talking, and talking. In Hebrew. All the time I'm smiling and nodding my head as if I understand what they're saying--like you told me to--but my head is really swimming and hurting from the wine and I'm dying of hunger. "The smell of the food from the kitchen is making me insane, but they don't bring it out. For two hours they don't bring anything out! Just talking, and more talking. Then, just what I needed.... another cup of wine! Then we get up, wash hands, sit back down and eat this big

	wafer called matzah that tastes like newspaper, leaning to the left (don't ask me why...). I started choking, almost threw up. And then finally they give me this lettuce, I took a big bite and wham! My mouth was on fire. My throat! There was horseradish inside! Nothing to eat but horseradish! You guys are crazy...." "Well, I just got up and left. Enough is enough!" "Ah, I should have told you." replied the Jew. "What a shame! After the bitter herbs is a glorious meal. You suffered so long; you should have just held out for a few more minutes...!"
	English Pesach songs TTTO. 'These are a few of my favorite things' etc.
Sh or Tu	Nirtzah: We end with praise and hope.... It's late and we have so much to think about and internalize, but we are upbeat that this WILL be the beginning of true redemption etc. etc....
Optional if appropriate – Act	End of Seder Wow that was an amazing Seder! Yes – what a night! It's been fun, but it's also made us think about how we should each improve and grow. There are SO many ways to grow. Maybe one way to grow is in the way we speak. Lots of people said things tonight about watching the way we SPEAK, so I'm certainly going to try speak more positively. From tonight onwards, let's <u>all</u> try to take steps towards personal freedom. TOGETHER: Chag Sameach everyone!
Chad Gadya	Each table makes another sound....